

Control Testing Policy

Independent assurance

OWNER	Security & GRC
EFFECTIVE	2026-07-13
REVIEW CYCLE	Annual or material change
CLASSIFICATION	Internal

1. Purpose and scope

This policy establishes how Cobalt Harbor Systems ensures that control design and operating effectiveness are tested with repeatable procedures and objective conclusions. It applies to personnel and approved providers performing the governed activity.

2. Control objectives

- Objective A.** Establish accountable, repeatable operating decisions for independent assurance.
Objective B. Produce evidence that supports independent assurance and timely remediation.

3. Required operating practices

1. Plan the activity with documented scope, owner, and timing appropriate to independent assurance.
2. Execute and record the activity using the required evidence attributes: test plan, sample rationale, workpapers, exceptions, conclusion, and remediation link.
3. Review exceptions and changes before they affect the control conclusion.
4. Preserve decisions and evidence in the approved repository for the stated retention period.

4. Accountability

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Test lead	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.
Control owner	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.
Quality reviewer	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.

Independent assurance: assurance criteria

5. Evidence standard

The accountable owner retains evidence that is sufficient to demonstrate the operating result. At minimum, each record includes: test plan, sample rationale, workpapers, exceptions, conclusion, and remediation link. Evidence is linked to the applicable system, review period, owner, and disposition so another qualified reviewer can reproduce the conclusion.

6. Measurement and reporting

MEASURE	OPERATING THRESHOLD
Primary metric	Testing plan completion and repeat-exception rate are reported each quarter
Quality review	Evidence completeness and sampled accuracy are reviewed monthly.
Management reporting	Trends, overdue actions, and material exceptions are reported to Security & GRC.

7. Noncompliance and escalation

A failed key control receives a corrective action owner and target date within ten business days The responsible owner documents the correction, root cause, and follow-up verification. Material deviations are included in the assurance register until closure.

8. Revision and approval

The policy owner reviews this policy annually, after a material control change, or following an assurance finding related to independent assurance. Revisions must identify changed obligations, affected owners, and implementation timing before approval.

APPROVER	ROLE	STATUS
Mira Patel	Director, Security & GRC	Approved
Jonah Reed	Control Assurance Lead	Reviewed